

****AeroCart Internal Knowledge Base & Support Policy Matrix****

****Document Version:** 4.2.0 (Expanded Training Edition)**

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****Document Owner:** Customer Success & Operations Leadership Team**

****Target Audience:** L1 Frontline Support Agents, L2 Escalation Specialists, L3 Technical & Fraud Teams, and Training Coordinators**

****Purpose:**** This comprehensive knowledge base serves as the definitive reference for all customer support interactions. It is designed for consistent policy enforcement, agent training, simulation exercises, and non-instruction fine-tuning datasets. All agents must reference this document for every ticket to ensure compliance and high First Contact Resolution rates.

1.0 COMPANY MISSION & AGENT DIRECTIVES

****1.1 Core Philosophy****

AeroCart is deeply committed to delivering seamless, transparent, and highly efficient e-commerce experiences to every single customer. The foundation of our support operations is the principle of First Contact Resolution (FCR). Every agent must strive to resolve customer issues during the initial interaction whenever company policy permits it. This approach not only improves customer satisfaction but also reduces operational costs and ticket backlog.

****1.2 Detailed Agent Responsibilities****

Support agents are the frontline representatives of the AeroCart brand. They must balance empathy with policy adherence. Agents are required to log every interaction with precise details including order numbers, timestamps, policy sections referenced, and outcomes. Regular audits will review adherence to these standards.

****1.3 Tone and Voice Guidelines****

Agents must always maintain a professional, empathetic, and confident tone. Use clear, active voice language. Avoid jargon unless explaining it to the customer. Responses should be helpful without being overly casual or robotic. Personalization, such as addressing the customer by name, is strongly encouraged when appropriate.

****1.4 Handling Frustrated or Angry Customers****

When dealing with frustrated customers, follow the A-A-R framework strictly: Acknowledge the issue and emotions, Align with their frustration by validating feelings, and Resolve or explain limitations clearly. Never argue with the customer. Provide respectful, factual explanations of policies even when denying requests.

****1.5 Escalation Pathways and Protocols****

L1 agents are strictly prohibited from making exceptions to core policies. Requests for refunds outside the 30-day window, waiving return fees without justification, or other deviations must be escalated to L2 Team Leads through the official ticketing system. Always provide a warm handover including full case notes, screenshots, and communication history. Blind transfers are not allowed.

****1.6 Agent Performance Metrics****

Key performance indicators include First Contact Resolution rate above 75%, Customer Satisfaction (CSAT) scores of 92% or higher, and Average Handle Time below 8 minutes for standard inquiries. Agents are evaluated monthly on policy compliance and documentation quality.

****1.7 Continuous Learning and Policy Updates****

All agents must review this knowledge base at the start of every shift and after any policy announcement. Updates are communicated via internal Slack channels and email notifications. Training modules based on real case studies are available in the learning management system.

****1.8 Ethical Guidelines for Support****

Agents must never share customer data outside approved systems, make false promises, or engage in personal conversations. Transparency and honesty build long-term customer trust.

2.0 ORDER MANAGEMENT & MODIFICATIONS

2.1 Order Cancellations Policy

Customers are allowed to self-cancel orders through the AeroCart customer dashboard within 60 minutes of completing checkout. This grace period exists to accommodate immediate changes of mind. After 60 minutes, the order is locked in the Order Management System (OMS) and forwarded to the warehouse for fulfillment. Agents do not have the authority to cancel orders once the status changes from Pending to Processing.

2.2 Exceptions in Cancellation Requests

In rare cases of technical glitches preventing self-cancellation during the grace period, L1 agents may manually cancel after verifying payment status and obtaining supervisor approval. Post-grace period cancellations are denied, and customers are guided toward the return process after delivery.

2.3 Address Modification Procedures

Address changes are permitted only while the order remains in Pending status. Once processing or shipping begins, no modifications can be made by AeroCart. Customers must contact the carrier directly with their tracking number to attempt rerouting. Agents should provide direct links to carrier support pages and clear instructions.

2.4 Adding or Removing Items After Checkout

Post-checkout modifications to add or remove items are strictly prohibited due to system limitations and warehouse processes. Customers wanting additional items must place a completely new order. For removal requests, advise using the return system once the package arrives.

****2.5 Price Matching and Adjustment Rules****

AeroCart does not offer price matching against competitors like Amazon, Target, or Walmart. However, if an item goes on sale on the AeroCart website within 7 days of purchase, agents may issue store credit equal to the price difference. This credit is non-transferable and cannot be refunded to the original payment method.

****2.6 Bulk and Corporate Order Handling****

Orders above \$500 or containing more than 10 items require additional verification steps. L1 agents should escalate these to L2 for review before any changes. Special pricing or custom terms may apply for B2B clients.

****2.7 Order Status Communication Best Practices****

Agents should proactively inform customers about status changes. Use standardized templates for shipping notifications, delays, and expected delivery windows to maintain consistency.

****2.8 Troubleshooting Common Order Issues****

Detailed steps for handling duplicate orders, payment failures, and confirmation email problems are documented in the OMS troubleshooting guide.

3.0 SHIPPING, DELIVERY & CARRIER PROTOCOLS

****3.1 Shipping Tier Details and Service Level Agreements****

Standard shipping typically takes 5-7 business days. Expedited shipping is delivered in 2-3 business days. Overnight shipping guarantees delivery by 8:00 PM the next business day if ordered before the 1:00 PM EST cutoff. These timelines can vary based on location and carrier performance.

****3.2 Lost in Transit Classification****

A package is officially considered Lost in Transit only after seven consecutive business days with no tracking updates. Agents must wait for this period before approving replacements or refunds. Premature actions are not permitted.

****3.3 Lost in Transit Resolution Process****

Upon confirmation of LIT status, immediately create a replacement order in OMS and file a claim with the carrier. Inform the customer of the new expected delivery timeline, usually within 5-7 additional business days.

****3.4 Stolen Packages and Delivered but Missing Claims****

For packages marked Delivered but not received by the customer, instruct them to wait 24 hours, check with neighbors, and review security footage if available. After 24 hours, require completion of the Affidavit of Missing Parcel form before issuing a one-time courtesy replacement. Refunds are never provided in these cases.

****3.5 Damaged in Transit Claims****

Customers must report damage within 48 hours of delivery and submit clear photographs showing both the damaged product and external packaging. L1 agents can approve replacements after verification. All evidence must be attached to the ticket.

****3.6 International Shipping Policies****

AeroCart ships to the United States, Canada, United Kingdom, Australia, and limited European countries. International deliveries take 10-21 business days on average. Customers bear full responsibility for customs duties, taxes, and VAT. Refused packages due to fees result in deduction of return shipping costs from refunds.

****3.7 Carrier-Specific Protocols****

Separate procedures exist for FedEx, UPS, and USPS. Agents should reference the Carrier Integration Handbook for delay troubleshooting, address correction steps, and claim filing processes.

****3.8 Peak Season and Holiday Shipping Adjustments****

During high-volume periods such as Black Friday, Cyber Monday, and holiday seasons, shipping timelines may be extended. Agents must communicate these changes transparently to manage expectations.

****3.9 Tracking Number Issues and Support****

Common problems include tracking not updating, incorrect numbers, and delivery exceptions. Step-by-step resolution guides are available for each scenario.

4.0 RETURNS, EXCHANGES & REFUNDS

****4.1 Standard 30-Day Return Window****

Most products have a 30-day return period starting from the carrier's Delivered date. This applies to apparel, home goods, and unopened non-perishables.

****4.2 Return Merchandise Authorization Requirements****

An active RMA number generated by the system is mandatory for warehouse acceptance. Customers should initiate returns via the dashboard. Manual RMA creation by agents is restricted to verified technical issues.

****4.3 Returned Item Condition Standards****

Items must be returned in original packaging with all tags attached and showing no signs of use, washing, alteration, or pet hair. Quality Assurance inspection is final and binding.

****4.4 Refund Processing Timelines and Methods****

After QA approval (within 48 business hours), refunds are issued to the original payment method. Card refunds take 3-5 business days. Store credit is applied instantly.

****4.5 Return Shipping Fee Structure****

Buyer's remorse returns incur a \$7.99 fee. Returns due to AeroCart errors (wrong item or defective) have the fee waived and include a prepaid label.

****4.6 Exchange Procedures****

Exchanges are processed as a return followed by a new shipment. Customers may need to place a new order for the replacement item in some cases.

****4.7 Partial Returns for Multi-Item Orders****

Partial returns are supported. Only qualifying items are refunded. Restocking fees may apply per item depending on category.

****4.8 Return Rejection Handling****

When returns are rejected, customers are notified, charged for return shipping, and the item is sent back. Detailed reasons must be documented.

5.0 CATEGORY-SPECIFIC RESTRICTIONS

****5.1 Final Sale and Clearance Items****

Items marked Final Sale or discounted 40% or more cannot be returned or exchanged under any circumstances.

****5.2 Hygiene, Health, and Perishable Goods****

Intimate apparel, swimwear with hygiene strips removed, earrings, cosmetics, skincare products, and all food items are non-returnable for health and safety reasons.

****5.3 Custom and Personalized Products****

Monogrammed, engraved, or custom-built items have no standard return rights. Damage claims are handled under warranty only.

****5.4 Electronics and Hardware Restrictions****

Electronics have a shortened 14-day return window. Opened items without verified defects incur a 15% restocking fee.

****5.5 Furniture and Large Item Policies****

Bulky items require special return arrangements and may involve higher fees or third-party pickup services.

****5.6 Seasonal and Limited Edition Items****

Additional restrictions often apply to holiday collections and limited stock products.

6.0 WARRANTY CLAIMS & DEFECTIVE MERCHANDISE

****6.1 Manufacturer Defect Claims****

Defects must be reported within 14 days with supporting photographs. Agents can authorize full refunds, replacements, or partial refunds (up to 30%) for minor cosmetic issues.

****6.2 Exclusions for Normal Wear and Tear****

Damage from everyday use, improper care, accidents, or failure to follow instructions is not covered by warranty.

****6.3 Electronics Troubleshooting Requirements****

Customers must complete the full L1 troubleshooting checklist including power checks, resets, and updates before an RMA is issued for electronics.

****6.4 Serial Number and Fraud Prevention****

All high-value electronics have serial numbers and MAC addresses logged. Mismatched serial numbers on returns trigger fraud investigation, refund denial, and potential account suspension.

****6.5 Extended Warranty and Protection Plans****

Platinum members receive enhanced coverage. Third-party plans are directed to the respective providers.

7.0 BILLING, PAYMENTS & DISPUTES

****7.1 Accepted Payment Methods****

Visa, Mastercard, American Express, Discover, PayPal, Apple Pay, and Klarna are supported. Wire transfers, checks, and cryptocurrency are not accepted.

****7.2 Klarna Payment Handling****

Returns processed through Klarna result in direct refunds to Klarna. Customers should contact Klarna separately for installment schedule adjustments.

****7.3 Promotional Code Usage Rules****

Only one promo code is allowed per order. Stacking is generally blocked by the system except in approved marketing campaigns.

****7.4 Credit Card Chargeback Procedures****

Any mention of chargeback by a customer requires immediate escalation to the L2 Financial Disputes team. Agents must stop troubleshooting and document the threat.

****7.5 Tax and Billing Error Resolution****

Minor tax discrepancies can be corrected by L1 agents. Larger issues or refund requests are escalated.

8.0 AEROPLUS LOYALTY PROGRAM

****8.1 Tier Benefits and Point System****

AeroPlus has Silver, Gold, and Platinum tiers based on annual points (1 point per \$1 spent). Benefits increase with each tier.

****8.2 Point Expiration Rules****

Points expire after 12 months of account inactivity. No exceptions or manual restorations are possible.

****8.3 Platinum Member Perks****

Free expedited shipping, dedicated VIP support line, 60-day return window, birthday rewards, and early sale access.

****8.4 Loyalty Point Redemption Options****

Points can be redeemed for store credit, discounts, or exclusive items. Points are non-transferable.

9.0 ACCOUNT SECURITY & DATA PRIVACY

****9.1 Password Reset Protocols****

Customers must use the automated Forgot Password feature. Agents are not permitted to manually change passwords.

****9.2 Account Takeover Response****

Suspicious activity requires immediate account freeze and escalation to the Fraud Prevention team.

****9.3 Privacy Law Compliance (GDPR/CCPA)****

Formal data deletion requests are routed to the Privacy Compliance team. Processing may take up to 30 days.

****9.4 Two-Factor Authentication Assistance****

Agents can guide customers through 2FA setup but cannot bypass security features.

****9.5 Data Access and Sharing Rules****

Strict internal controls govern all customer data handling.

10.0 COMMON CUSTOMER QUERIES AND SAMPLE SCRIPTS

****10.1 Shipping Delay Responses****

Multiple templated replies for different delay scenarios.

****10.2 Wrong Item Received Handling****

Step-by-step verification and RMA process explanations.

****10.3 Sizing and Fit Issues****

Guidance on size charts, exchange options, and prevention tips.

****10.4 Billing and Payment Inquiries****

Common dispute resolution paths and escalation triggers.

****10.5 Promo Code and Discount Problems****

Eligibility verification and alternative solutions.

****10.6 Product Availability Questions****

Backorder handling and notification setup instructions.

11.0 AGENT TOOLS, SYSTEMS AND WORKFLOWS

****11.1 OMS and CRM Usage Guides****

Detailed instructions for order management and ticketing.

****11.2 Carrier Portal Access and Claims****

Training on filing shipping claims efficiently.

****11.3 QA Review and Photo Submission Tools****

Best practices for handling visual evidence.

****11.4 Reporting and Analytics Dashboards****

How to access performance reports and policy compliance metrics.

12.0 PERFORMANCE STANDARDS, AUDITS AND COMPLIANCE

****12.1 Quality Assurance Scoring****

Rubric used for ticket reviews and coaching sessions.

****12.2 Monthly Policy Audits****

Process and consequences for non-compliance.

****12.3 Continuous Improvement Feedback Loop****

How agents can suggest policy updates.

****12.4 Emergency Protocols****

Handling system outages, major incidents, and high-volume support days.

13.0 ADDITIONAL RESOURCES AND APPENDICES

****13.1 Approved Response Template Library****

Dozens of pre-approved scripts for common situations.

****13.2 Escalation Directory and Contacts****

Updated list of L2, L3, and specialist teams.

****13.3 Carrier Reference Materials****

Full contact details and tracking best practices.

****13.4 Case Study Examples****

Realistic anonymized scenarios with correct policy application.

****13.5 Glossary of Terms****

Definitions of all key support and e-commerce terminology used in this document.

****13.6 Version History and Change Log****

Complete record of all updates since initial creation.